SpendWise: A Simple Backend Learning Project
Ideation Phase
Empathize & Discover

Date	13 February 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-3987
Project Name	SpendWise
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas:

An empathy map is a simple way to understand a beginner's thoughts, feelings, and actions while learning backend development. It helps identify how beginners work with APIs, JWT authentication, and MongoDB, and what problems they face with complex code. Creating this empathy map allows the project to be viewed from the beginner's perspective, ensuring the solution stays simple, practical, and easy to understand.

Example:

Empathy Map

SpendWise Project

What does the THINK & FEEL?

- Wants to learn backend development in a practical way
- Feels confused about how JWT, APIs, and MongoDB work together
- Worries about building a "complete" project for submission
- Aspires to become confident in backend concepts
- Cares about understanding CRUD operations clearly

What does he user SEE?

- Sees many complex projects online that are hard to understand
- Sees tutorials with too much code and little explanation
- Sees classmates building backend projects for college
- Sees the need for a simple, working backend example
- Sees tools like Postman, MongoDB, and js being used in industry

Student / Beginner Backend Developer

What does he HEAR?

- Teachers say: "You must know CRUD and authentication"
- Friends say: "Make a simple project for submission"
- Seniors say: "Learn JWT and MongoDB, it's important"
- Online videos say: "Backend needs practice, not just theory"
- Peers talk about using GitHub for projects

What does SAY & DO?

- Says: "I want a simple project to understand backend"
- Says: "JWT is confusing, I need a clear example"
- Builds small APIs and tests them in Postman
- Tries to connect MongoDB and fix errors
- Pushes project code to GitHub for projects

Pain

- Gets confused by large and complex projects
- Struggles to connect authentication with database
- Errors in MongoDB connection and JWT tokens
- Fear of not understanding backend concepts properly

Gain

- Wants a simple, working backend project
- Needs clear understanding of CRUD + JWT + MongoDB
- Success = APIs working in Postman
- Success = Can explain project in viva/interview
- Success = Project uploaded on GitHub and rurs correctly

This empathy map shows that students need a simple, practical backend project to understand JWT authentication, CRUD operations, and MongoDB, and **SpendWIse** is designed exactly to solve this problem.

Says

- I want a simple project to learn backend
- I understand theory, but coding it is different
- JWT is confusing, I need a clear example
- I just want to register, login, and manage data

What does the user SEE?

- How do APIs, JWT, and MongoDB connect together?
- This project should not be too complex
- I need practice for interviews
- I hope I can remember this for my viva

Student / Beginner
Backend Developer

Does

- Searches for simple Node.js + MongoDB projects
- Watches tutorials and tries them out
- Tests APIs in Postman/Thunder Client
- Pushes code to GitHub for practice

Feels

- Confused by large projects with lots of code
- Happy when small APIs work as expected
- Frustrated when JWT tokens do not work
- Motivated if I can explain my backend in in a viva

Pain

- Searches for large projects with lots of code
- Watches tutorials and tries them out
- Tests APIs in Postman/Thunder Client
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Feels

- Confused by large projects with lots of code
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